

THE STRANGEST SECRET

Earl Nightingale is a legend to authors, speakers, and radio hosts like me. In 1956, he produced a spoken-word record—the early ancestor of today’s audiobook—that became the first spoken-word record to go gold in sales. It sold more than a million copies, which was unheard of for a recording of this type in the fifties. The name of that recording is *The Strangest Secret*, and it has changed countless lives over the past sixty years. What is the “strangest secret”? What is it that makes some succeed where others fail? For Nightingale, it all comes down to one simple truth: we become what we think about. He compares it to planting a seed, saying, “The ground will always return what is planted.” Therefore, if you plant tomatoes, you’ll get tomatoes. In the same way, if you plant a seed of success in your mind, you’ll get success. If you plant a seed of fear and doubt, you’ll get a crop of fear and doubt. The ground doesn’t *care* what you plant, but it will always *return* what you planted.

Now that we’ve destroyed the myths about millionaires that hold many people back, I want to challenge you to replace those myths and lies with truth. The truth matters. Every day you are planting seeds in your mind—seeds of hope, wealth, and success or seeds of doubt, fear, and failure. If you want to reap the same harvest that our 10,000 millionaires have reaped, you’ve got to plant the type of seeds that they’ve planted. So let’s get a better look at the key attributes of the everyday American millionaire. We’ll start with something we’ve already noticed in the stories I’ve shared, something 97% of millionaires agree on: the power of personal responsibility. You’ll see that you—yes, *you*—are responsible for your money, your financial choices, and your dreams of reaching financial independence.